



Forsa 7600GS

Affordable and able

A new name in the graphics card market in India, Forsa's 7600GS is based around NVIDIA's mid-level 7 series chipset, the 7600GS. Like the mighty 7900 GTX, this chip, too, is manufactured using NVIDIA's latest 90 nm fabrication process. The core is clocked at a sedate 400 MHz, while the 256 MB of GDDR2 memory is clocked at 800 MHz. The 7600GS is an underclocked variant of the 7600 GT core, the successor of the much-acclaimed 6600 GT. This, coupled with the 12 pixel shader / 5 vertex shader architecture, means that this card is reasonably well equipped to run all but the most demanding games (such as *F.E.A.R.* and *Oblivion*), and at all but the most demanding resolutions.

The 7600GS chipset fully supports Shader model 3.0, coupled with NVIDIA's Cine FX 4.0. All this means you won't miss out on the eye candy, and can crank up the visuals to high settings in most games. The card is nicely laid out with a decent cooler and silent fan combo, which keeps temperatures in check efficiently. The Forsa 7600GS performed decently in our tests—43-odd frames in *DOOM 3* at 1024 x 768 at ultra high settings with 4x Anti-Aliasing enabled is not by any means bad. The card does take a hit with AA and AF enabled, and as the *Far Cry* test shows, enabling newer features such as HDR (High Dynamic Range) will further take a toll. For the gamer on a budget who can do

without the over-the-top eye candy like AA and HDR, you'll be rewarded with some sweet frame rates, and since you only shell out Rs 6,700, the deal's sweet. We were impressed by the frames we got in *F.E.A.R.*, very decent for such a card, since this game engine brings even the fastest cards down to a crawl! Forsa is a little skimpy on the bundled contents though—no games, and only a single S-Video connector. For a mid-range card, we'd have appreciated at least one full-version game.

Specifications

NVIDIA GeForce 7600GS chipset, 256 MB DDR2 memory, core speed 400 MHz, SM 3.0 support, NVIDIA's Cine FX 4.0

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★●
Features	★★★★●
Package contents	★★★★●
Value for money	★★★★●
Overall	★★★★●

Contact: Shree Sagarmatha Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-23065114 / 23200032
E-mail: sagarmatha_mumbai@mtnl.net.in
Web site: www.techcomindia.com
Price: Rs 6,700

JBL ON TIME

Posh and pricey

JBL's ON TIME is an iPod dock that integrates sound with a digital clock, making for a good bedside portable audio player. Available in iPod white and black finishes, the design is elegant. Subtle use of chrome, a blue backlight, and an inverted LCD display blends well with the white body.

Apart from good looks, the ON TIME dock is peppered with interesting features. To begin with, the universal dock ensures compatibility across a wide generation of iPods and also nano players. When docked, these players are automatically charged. The dock offers rudimentary controls such as sound, source selection, etc., but for skipping tracks, one has to use the iPod controls. The dock has an auxiliary input which allows for connecting other MP3 players, laptops, etc. It integrates FM and AM radio as the third audio source, and setting up preset stations is a snap.

The dock integrates a nice digital clock with two alarms and the snooze function. Setting up the alarms is quite simple, and the snooze timer can be set from as low as one minute to a maximum of 30 minutes. As for the alarm tone, you can choose to wake up to your favourite song from the iPod. The large reversed LCD display has good contrast and is quite sharp, so the digits are legible from a distance.

Coming to the audio quality, it leaves a lot to be desired. The ON TIME, despite being from JBL, doesn't inspire much: it lacks clarity and depth when the volume is set below 30 per cent. The speakers start sounding better when the volume is raised past the 50 to 60 per cent mark. Now that's not ideal for a bedside player, which will mostly be set at low volumes.

An interesting feature includes a light sensor that regulates backlighting on the fly, and this works pretty well. The dock has an audio-out that can be connected to an active sub-woofer for additional boom.

Priced at Rs 17,990, JBL's ON TIME is expensive for sure, but then lifestyle products are more about exclusivity than price. Based on the average audio quality, however, we cannot recommend the ON TIME as a good buy.

Specifications

6 W neodymium speakers and tweeters, universal iPod dock, 3.5 mm mini stereo auxiliary jack, sub-woofer out, and frequency response of 70 Hz - 20 KHz

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★●
Ease of use	★★★★●
Build quality	★★★★●
Value for money	★★★★●
Overall	★★★★●

Contact: Shahil International
Phone: 022-30912565 / 23862345
E-mail: firoz@fxaudio.com
Web site: www.fxaudio.com
Price: 17,990

